

This, however, was the work which, as we know from Neh., the Jews took up in the days of Artaxerxes. The allusion in *v.* 12 appears to be to the Jews who had returned in 458 with Ezra.

All recent writers on Ezra agree in this view of the *contents* of 4, 6-23: they only differ in their explanation of the disregard of chronological sequence shown here by the compiler. Bertheau, Keil, Oettli suppose that, though aware in fact that the section related to occurrences some 80 years later than the period he was describing (4, 1-5. c. 5-6), he inserted it here "episodically," or with the view of "giving a synopsis of the entire series of hostilities experienced by the Jews at the hands of their neighbours." But this explanation cannot be deemed a probable one; it is difficult to think that a method which could only mislead and confuse the reader would have been adopted by the compiler intentionally. It is far more natural to suppose that, for some reason, the true reference of the section was not perceived by him; and that he referred by error to troubles connected with the restoration of the Temple what related in fact to the restoration of the city walls.¹

The letter to Artaxerxes, and his reply, 4, 8-23, are taken by the compiler from an *Aramaic* source; 4, 24 is generally thought to have been added by him partly as a comment on his interpretation of their contents (Schrader, p. 474; Ryssel; Kuenen), partly for the purpose of connecting 4, 1-5 with 5, 1 ff.

5, 1-6, 18 is another extract from an *Aramaic* source, the same, probably, as that from which 4, 8-23 is derived.

What the nature of this *Aramaic* source may have been, can, of course, only be conjectured; Bertheau, p. 6 (= Ryssel, p. xiii), supposes it to have been a narrative of the troubles which arose between the returned exiles and their neighbours, down to the period of Artaxerxes. Stade (ii. 188) thinks it may have been a more comprehensive history of the restored community. It certainly appears to have been a thoroughly trustworthy document (cf. Stade, ii. 100), though the edicts contained in it, so far as their *form* is concerned,

¹ Of course there would be no occasion for this reference of 4, 6-23, could it be shown, or even rendered probable, that Achashwêrosh and Artachshasta were other names of Cambyses and Pseudo-Smerdis respectively (for the second reason stated above, though it corroborates the first, would not, if it stood alone, be decisive; the expressions in *v.* 12 f. might be due to an exaggeration). This was the opinion of Ewald (*Hist.* v. 105 f.); but it has been abandoned by later writers (see Keil on 4, 24; Ryssel, p. 63 f.) as a hypothesis insufficiently warranted by the facts.

are open to the suspicion of having been coloured by their transmission through Jewish hands. Notice in 6, 9. 10. 12 the technical expressions of the Jewish law; in *v.* 10 "savour of satisfaction; in *v.* 12^a a phrase characteristic of Dt. (p. 94, No. 35). The dialect in which it is written (including the edicts) is the Western, or *Palestinian*, Aramaic (p. 471).

6, 19-22 (where the Hebrew recommences) the compiler (as is plain from the phraseology) speaks again in his own person.¹

The second section of the book, c. 7-10, dealing with Ezra's own age, there is no reason to doubt, is throughout either written by Ezra or based upon materials left by him. 7, 27-9, 15—with the exception, as it seems, of occasional glosses or slight additions made by the compiler—is thus an extract from Ezra's own memoirs. But 7, 1-10 is certainly not Ezra's work, though doubtless composed on the basis of Ezra's materials; it is manifestly a summary account of Ezra, prefixed by the compiler as an introduction to the excerpt from Ezra's memoirs which follows.

In 7, 1-10 notice (*a*) the omission of Ezra's immediate ancestors (for Seraiah was contemporary with Zedekiah, 2 Ki. 25, 18. 21, 130 years previously to Ezra's time); (*b*) the fact that *vv.* 7-9 anticipate c. 8; (*c*) the expressions of the compiler in *v.* 10 (p. 503, Nos. 6, 7; esp. 2 Ch. 12, 14. 19, 3. 30, 19). The phrase in *vv.* 6 *end.* 9 *end.* will be naturally taken from Ezra's memoirs (see 7, 28). In 7, 27-9, 15, the clause in 8, 20 "whom," &c., for instance, reads like an explanatory gloss; notice also *ו*, never besides in *Ezr.* *Neh.*, and only twice in *Ch.*, I 5, 20. 27, 27; the last clause of the verse includes a phrase of the compiler's (p. 503, No. 12). And 8, 35 f. (unlike the context) is written without reference to Ezra himself; it is not improbable therefore that it may have been condensed by the compiler from Ezra's own more detailed and personal description. The decree of Artaxerxes, 7, 12-26, as is evident from the terms of 7, 27, must also have stood in Ezra's memoirs, though it may have been cast into its present form by one familiar with the terminology of the Jewish sacred books (see *vv.* 13^b [p. 504, No. 23]. 15. 16. 17. 24. 26; comp. Ewald, i. 191). The dialect, as before, is the Palestinian Aramaic. In *substance*, it is undoubtedly genuine (Stade, ii. 153).

C. 10, though the immediate sequel of c. 9, is distinguished from it by the use of the third person, and also by being in parts considerably less circumstantial (see especially the brief and incomplete notices in *vv.* 15. 16 f.): at the same time, in other

¹ Perhaps, indeed (Schrad. p. 477; Ryssel, pp. xiv, xix; Kuen. § 34. 9), *vv.* 16-18 are also due to the compiler, who, designing them as the conclusion of the *Aramaic* narrative of the building of the Temple, may have written them in the same language.

respects the particulars are full and graphic (*vv.* 9^b. 13); so that in all probability the narrative has merely been somewhat altered in form, and abridged, from the memoirs of Ezra.¹

Neh. 1, 1—7, 73^a is an excerpt, to all appearance unaltered, from the memoirs of Nehemiah,—the register, 7, 6—73^a (relating to the time of Zerubbabel), being, of course, as expressly stated in *v.* 5^b, an earlier document found by Nehemiah, and incorporated by him in his memoirs.

In Neh. 7, 73^b—c. 10 *Ezra* reappears; and both Ezra and Nehemiah are mentioned in the third person (8, 1—6 &c.: in 8, 9. 10, 1 alone Nehemiah receives the Persian title, “the Tirshatha” [cf. 7, 65. 70. *Ezr.* 2, 63 of Zerubbabel]). The connexion of the section with 1, 1—7, 73^a is also imperfect; for 7, 73^b. c. 8 is not the sequel to 7, 4—5 (Neh.’s purpose to class the people genealogically), but relates to an entirely different matter, viz. the people’s engaging to observe the Mosaic law. It cannot therefore be regarded as a continuation of Nehemiah’s narrative, though it is not questioned that it is based upon a well-informed, contemporary source, perhaps here and there modified by the compiler: by many critics this source is supposed to be the memoirs of Ezra.

So Ewald, *Hist.* i. 192; Berth. p. 8; Schrader, *Eintl.* § 237; Ryssel, pp. xvi, xx; Oettli, p. 150; and at least for 9, 6—10, 40 (except the list of names, 10, 3—14 [2—13]) Stade, *Gesch.* ii. 153, 178, 179, who points to the great similarity of the prayer in c. 9 with that in *Ezr.* 9 (in Neh. 9, 6 the words *And Ezra spake* should very possibly be restored from the LXX: so Berth., Ryssel, Stade). It is true, the section exhibits *some* affinities with the style of the compiler; but they are not here sufficiently numerous or marked to indicate identity of author: they are rather (as in the case of *Ezr.* 7, 27—c. 9) due to the fact that the theme is in part similar (the functions of the Levites, theocratic ordinances, &c.), and that some of the expressions used by the Chronicler were already current in Ezra’s time. It is remarked justly by Kuenen, that in point of grammar and literary style Neh. 7, 73^b—c. 10 stands on a much higher level than the narratives which proceed from the pen of the Chronicler: so the prayer in c. 9, for instance, shows no traces of his peculiar mannerisms. For details of the style, see Kuenen, § 34. 13.

To c. 11, on the other hand, the remark in 7, 4 forms a natural introduction,² though the narrative is hardly continued *uno*

¹ Keil’s explanation (*Eintl.* § 146. 3) of the change of person is most inadequate.

² So Ew. v. 159 *note*; Kuen. § 29. 9; Smend, p. 23; Stade, ii. 98, 174; Ryssel, p. xix.